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TRANSITION YEAR SO FAR

TY Newsletter



Upcoming Events

- Self-defence in the church on Tuesday
9.55am: St. Michael's
11.11am: St. Blessed Dina's
12.12pm: St. Anthony's
- Social Dancing Classes on Wednesday Continues
- GAA Coaching On Thursday
- Swapped PE activities continues

Induction day

Although the year has just begun, we have already been very busy with a variety of workshops and fun activities. The 25/26 TY year welcomed 59 students, divided into three classes: St. Blessed Dinas, St. Michael's and St. Antony's. On our very first day back, the school kindly organised workshops including martial arts, team games, and percussion and drums. Our first workshop was martial arts and boxing. We warmed up with fun races and hurdles before learning correct punching, kicking, and blocking techniques, as well as how to do them safely. Then, we moved on to the pads where we practiced different combinations of punches, kicks, and blocks, as well as

defending ourselves. The class really enjoyed this tiring but exciting session. Partner work helped us get to know our classmates better. Overall, it was a very enjoyable experience and we learned a lot. After a short break, our second activity was percussion. We learned to clap different beats and rhythms, which was fascinating to see how our hands could make music. We then played tamboo bamboo, traditional instruments from Trinidad and Tobago made from plastic tubes, learning different beats. Everyone enjoyed playing these instruments and learning about them. The last activity of the day was team building games. These included

finding classmates who could cook a meal, have visited another country, or could drive a tractor. We also played relay Connect Four and a game similar to the floor is lava where we had to cross the basketball courts. The day ended with some gymnastics moves such as shoulder stands and grappling. Overall, it was a really fun and active day that everyone enjoyed, helping us get to know our new classmates better.

Digital Editor: Justin Jijo
Print Editor: Sam Lattimore
By : St. Blessed Dina's

Wildlands Trip

On Wednesday, the 3rd of September, TY students went on a bonding trip to Wildlands in Galway. They had an early start, leaving Gortnor Abbey at 7:30 via Willie B Coaches and arriving at Wildlands around 10 o'clock.

There were five activities to choose from. Blessed Dina's started with the Challenge Rooms—24 unique rooms each featuring a physical, mental or mixed challenge inspired by ancient Irish stories like St. Patrick and the Giant's Causeway. We formed groups and tackled the rooms, some of which were tough but all were enjoyable and fun. Next, Blessed Dina's experienced the ziplines. After fitting harnesses and receiving a safety briefing, we took off on thrilling ziplines high above the ground, which brought a mix of

adrenaline and excitement. After the ziplines, lunch was served with choices of pepperoni pizza, margarita pizza, or chicken goujons, all served with chips. The food was delicious and after eating we had some time to relax.

Our next activity was bouncing on the trampolines, where we jumped



freely and enjoyed features like a ball

pit, big swing, slides and basketball hoops. The trampolines were a favourite for many.

Following this, we tried rock climbing on various walls of differing difficulty, including timed climbs and boulders connected by chains. Jumping off at the top was nerve-wracking but added to the thrill. The climbing walls were very enjoyable. The last activity was disc golf, which we played briefly before the day's excitement caught up with us.

After finishing all activities, the year group gathered for a group photo before boarding the bus home. This bonding day was a great chance to hang out with friends, make new ones, and get to know new classmates better.

School Of Life

On Wednesday the 24th of September the TY's had the School of Life, where we were taught different skills of life like how to greet someone properly and pleasantly, how to tie a tie and how to iron a shirt.

At the start of the class Michelle showed us how to shake someone's hand properly. When we mastered that, she gave us different scenarios that we could use this skill in. She told us to always be formal and polite.

We were then taught how to tie a tie. She also taught us about coordination by giving us instructions like "grab with your right hand" or "swap to your left" which helped us concentrate.

Lastly we were taught how to iron a shirt. Michelle gave us a 6 minute demonstration of how to do it properly, then she split us up into teams. Each team had a crumpled up shirt and had to iron under 6 minutes. Once we were finished, we were judged by Eoin, Ruairi and Patrick. Sara, Sam and Saoirse won the competition. We were taught very valuable life skills and everyone learned something new.

Stay Safe, Say Sober!

On October 2nd TY's had a talk about how to celebrate safely when we get our Junior Cycle results safely.

Garda Mick, a community officer and Bernie, from the drug squad came in to speak to us.

They gave us some information about hanging out with our friends safely without breaking the law. We were also taught what to do when helping others who are intoxicated and are a danger to themselves or others.

It was not only advice that we will use on results night, but also later in life.

No Name Club

On Thursday the 18th of September the TY's received a talk about a club in their local area of Crossmolina. Siobhán and Grace came and talked about what they do in the club. They had mentioned so many fun enjoyable activities they do throughout the year such as day trips like bowling, watching films in the cinema, laser tag adventure centres and so much more. They had even mentioned a few trips where you get to stay overnight. They meet with all the members every Monday from 7pm-9pm. It is a time for older teenagers to just relax and chat with their friends. It is an amazing way for the TY's to expand their friend circles and meet new people. Siobhán and Grace talked to us about the importance of staying away from drugs and alcohol.



Dreamspace

The Dream Space Ambassador Program is a flagship Dream Space Student Leadership and training program, supported by the Dream Space Team in Dublin and Belfast. As part of this program, Dream Space Ambassadors become Dream Space specialists in their primary, second-level or Youthreach setting, offering assistance to fellow students and educators in the form of demos, training, leading small groups, or one-on-one sessions.



Girls Gaelic

On Tuesday the 16th of September the Gortnor Abbey junior girls took on Ballinrobe in their first match of the school year at home. Our junior team consists of girls from 2nd, 3rd and TY year groups. Ballinrobe took the lead getting the first point of the game but the Gortnor girls quickly came back and leveled it. The girls put up a great fight against Ballinrobe and we were six points down at half time.

In the second half the girls went out determined to level the score. With the weather against us, it was a very wet and windy day, so it was hard for our girls to perform their best. We tried our best but unfortunately we did not get the results we wanted with Ballinrobe taking the win.

TY PE Swimming and Golf

On the 26th of September, the TY's went golfing and swimming. They left for Ballina Golf Club and the swimming pool to start their activities. When they arrived, there was a member there to greet them and take them to the driving range and putting green. They split into groups and went to the areas. The putting and the driving range was enjoyable and exciting with competitions and games. The TYs enjoyed golfing as it gave them a new experience of trying a different sport and a chance to show off their skills.



Pictures of our wonderful day!!

Careers Fair

On Friday 26th the TY's took part in a careers fair held in Gortnor Abbey. Different employers talked to them about their jobs and career paths. They got an opportunity to talk to Guards, Entrepreneurs, Solicitors and even Funeral directors. This was a great way to explore different career paths and future jobs, and gave them an insight into the working world.

Halloween



Our TY students organised a spooktacular fancy dress competition in aid of the Gavin Glynn Foundation. The creativity and effort that went into the costumes were truly incredible. 1st place went to Joey Keane (6th Year), 2nd place went to Meabh Nealon (2nd Year) and 3rd place went to Dylan Flynn (6th Year).



Social Dancing

On Wednesday the 5th of November the TYs started their social dancing classes. They went to the church in groups and met Gerry Griffin. Gerry will be giving the TYs lessons in waltzing and line dancing but also in life. The dancing will give the TYs life skills for the future and will boost their confidence in it.

